

Next Steps

We hope you find the concepts outlined here helpful for your daily work. Should you be interested in finding out more about how we work and how you can get involved, please visit digital.auto.

We helped co-initiate digital.auto as an open and vendor-neutral community to enable our industry to use the SDV to deliver all the exciting use cases we have been talking about here. We do this via different collaboration and thought leadership activities, including this publication. In addition, the digital.auto community has worked together to create a number of open source activities.

Figure 6-1 maps the digital.auto focus areas against the #digitalfirst SDV lifecycle introduced in [Chapter 1](#).

First, we focus on advancing methods and tools to support early stage virtual exploration of SDV experiences. In particular, we created the [autowrx](#) open source project in the Eclipse SDV working group. This is a cloud-based, rapid-prototyping environment for the SDV. A free-to-use instance can be accessed via playground.digital.auto. This playground can be used to rapidly try out new ideas for the SDV against real vehicle APIs, which are simulated in the backend to get realistic test data. The resulting prototypes can be used to get early customer feedback and learn more about requirements, including the APIs needed for the new application. Prototypes developed in the playground can be directly deployed onto real SDV platforms (e.g., the Eclipse Velocitas open source SDV runtime). The digital.auto playground is open source and free to use. You can try it out at playground.digital.auto. We look forward to your feedback!

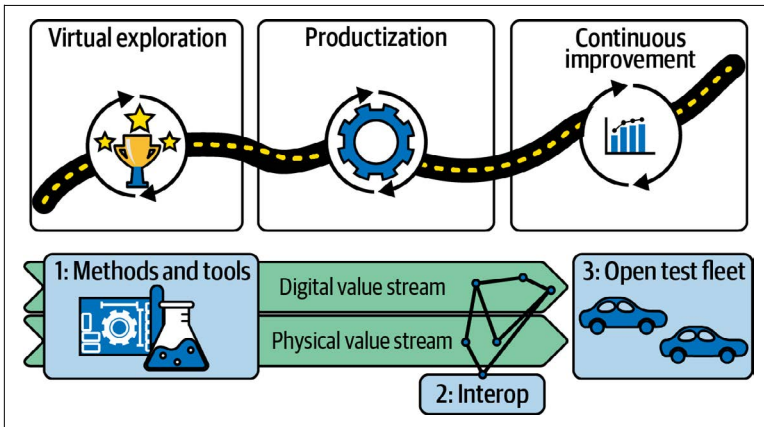


Figure 6-1. The digital.auto focus areas

Second, we are fostering interoperability along the SDV value chain. To support a #digitalfirst approach, a number of tools and technical platforms must be seamlessly integrated, from early-stage testing over virtualized development in the cloud to deployment on the target vehicle hardware. The site [interop.digital.auto](https://www.interop.digital.auto) summarizes our current activities in this space and provides a number of interop proof points we have implemented in the digital.auto community.

Third, we believe that to unlock the full potential of the SDV, we must create a vibrant ecosystem of OEMs, start-ups, developers, and innovators, all working together to try out new, exciting use cases. This will require a test infrastructure for SDVs that is not yet available. Our vision is to work together on an open test fleet for SDVs, including an open app store for experimental new features, executed in a safe environment. If this sounds intriguing to you, visit www.digital.auto and contact us to help make this vision become a reality.

About the Authors

Dirk Slama is a vice president at Robert Bosch GmbH and chair of the digital.auto initiative. He is also the director of the AIoT Lab at the Ferdinand-Steinbeis-Institute, where he holds a full professorship. Dirk has 25 years experience in large-scale IT projects in automotive, manufacturing, finance, and telecoms. He is coauthor of four books, with more than 50,000 copies sold. His academic credentials include a PhD in information systems, an MBA, and a diploma in computer science.

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